

Ricardo Vieira

Football Data Analyst

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Skills

Football data

Event data in Opta and StatsBomb schemas. xG and xGOT, expected pass, expected points, possession adjusted metrics, player similarity, role clustering.

Analysis and modelling

Python, pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, LightGBM, SQL and PostgreSQL, model validation and calibration.

Data engineering

ETL pipelines, web scraping with Playwright, entity resolution, schema design, Docker.

Visualisation and tooling

Custom interactive dashboards, Plotly, Tableau, Power BI, TypeScript and React.

Education

Postgraduate, Big Data Applied to Football

[Sports Data Campus](#) and UCAM, 60 ECTS
Nov 2024 to Aug 2025. Graduated 95/100

BSc Computer Science

[Universidade do Minho](#)
Oct 2016 to Jul 2020

Languages

Portuguese (native)

English (fluent)

Football analyst and developer with a postgraduate degree in Big Data Applied to Football (95/100). My final project produced an original versatility metric, published as an open source Python package. Alongside my job I build and run Pitchwatch, a public Liga Portugal analytics platform covering seven seasons of event data, where I do all of it: ingestion, the models on top of it, and the match, team and player reports that make the output usable.

Selected work

Pitchwatch, Liga Portugal analytics platform

Independent, 2026 to present

Built and maintained solo, alongside full-time work. Live at pitchwatch.rjvieira.com

- Built and operate the ingestion pipeline: 2.8 million events across 1,872 matches and seven Liga Portugal seasons, reconciled from two independent providers by fuzzy entity matching. The matchday sync runs unattended, with backfills chained behind it and recovery for events that arrive incomplete.
- Trained an expected pass model that assigns every pass a completion probability from its origin, destination, pass type qualifiers and game state. Validated on held-out matches, with calibration checked per pitch zone and separately for open play and set pieces rather than on one aggregate figure.
- Clustered players by how they actually play, from touch locations and per 90 output rather than the position they are listed at. It surfaces players whose listed position hides what they contribute, the kind of mismatch a position filter misses in recruitment screening.
- Added an expected points table from a double-Poisson model over match xG, separating results from underlying performance in the standings.
- Designed the analyst-facing output: match reports, player and team profiles, head to head, percentile charts against position and role peer groups, pass sonars, pass zone and box-entry maps, shot maps and similarity search. React front end, NestJS and PostgreSQL API on a VPS I administer, with CI and a documented deploy process.

Tactical Versatility Index (TVI)

2025

Final project for the postgraduate degree, with Luís Simões and Vitor Lopes. Published as [tvi-footballindex](#) on PyPI.

- Designed a metric measuring how versatile a player is, from which of seven action types they complete successfully in each of six functional pitch zones, normalised per minute played and bounded between 0 and 1. Applied to Opta event data from the big five leagues and the Primeira Liga, 2024/25.
- Weighted each action type by the inverse of its 95th percentile rather than by z score, because the underlying actions are not normally distributed and rare ones like shots on target would otherwise count for almost nothing.
- Tested it against a Shannon entropy version of the same idea, to check whether versatility is better captured by the diversity of a player's actions or by how evenly they are spread across the pitch. Zones, action set and weights are all parameters, so it runs against other datasets.

Experience

Exeedme

May 2025 to present

Full Stack Developer

Braga, Portugal

- One of three developers building and running the company's products, currently ggc.com and skinsprotocol.com, both consumer platforms in the CS2 skins market handling real money transactions.
- Involved in each feature from the initial idea and architecture through to shipping it and keeping it running afterwards, across several products at once.

Forca Tech Agency

May 2024 to Jan 2025

Full Stack Developer

Remote

- Built data visualisation components and automated data processing pipelines for a fintech analytics platform.
- Delivered features across the stack in Next.js and TypeScript, then worked on the backend migration to NestJS, with international clients in a distributed team.

Exeedme

Apr 2021 to Jul 2023

Lead Frontend Developer. Led front-end development across the company's projects, owning architecture and stack decisions.

Braga, Portugal